

Verbal Reasoning

Verbal reasoning is the ability to understand and reason using concepts that are framed in words. It aims to assess a child's ability to think constructively with a series of verbal reasoning questions.

Children perform better in verbal reasoning tests if they read widely and have an extensive vocabulary. Playing lots of word games at home can also help your child with verbal reasoning tests. Try activities such as letter tile games, crosswords and word searches.

The types of questions a child might be asked could focus on:

- finding synonyms and antonyms;
- finding a letter that will complete two words, e.g. woo (d) oor;
- finding a word hidden inside another word, e.g. the word pen hidden inside independent;
- spotting the odd one out in a list of words;
- breaking a code where each letter of the alphabet is represented by a different letter or number.

Here is an example of the type of question you may get in this section:

Circle the three-letter word that would complete the word in capital letters so the sentence makes sense. The letters cannot be rearranged.

The lioness **SLY** approached her prey.

BAT

OWL

ELK

APE

The answer to this question would be 'OWL' to make the sentence say, 'The lioness **SLOWLY** approached her prey.'

For a thorough guide to all aspects of the 11+ test, try our [Survival Guide for Parents/Carers](#).

Complete the Word

'Complete the Word' is a challenge where you have to find the missing word.

Many words in the English language have other, shorter words hidden inside them.

For example:

Take the word **spins**. Inside the word, we can find the word **pin** – **spins**.

In 'complete the word' challenges, you are usually given a sentence where one of the words is missing three consecutive letters. The word in question is usually written in capital letters.

Then, you are given several options for three-letter words that might fit into the original word to complete it.

For example, look at this question:



**Even though Jack had eaten all his dinner,
he was looking forward to PUDG.**

TEN

DIN

BED

INK



The answer is DIN because we can add it to this space in PUD__G to make PUDDING.



11+ Verbal Reasoning Practice Paper

Complete the Word: Test 1

Circle the three-letter word that would complete the word in capital letters so the sentence makes sense.

1.

Sarah wanted to CELEBE at her birthday party.

answer

RAT

CAT

BAT

DOE

2.

Samir made a mess when cooking in the KITC.

answer

EWE

ANT

CAT

HEN

3.

The school council had a DEE about the new playground equipment.

answer

CAT

BAT

DOE

COW

4.

Peter became very FRUSTED when completing the puzzle.

answer

EWE

COW

RAT

DOG



5.
Amelia and Usman used a secret E when writing notes to each other.

answer

ANT

SOW

RAY

COD

6.
Mum took ADVAGE of the sale in the clothes shop and bought lots of items.

answer

OWL

COD

ANT

DOG

7.
Upset, Rocco SCED down at his shoes.

answer

RAT

OWL

HEN

COW

8.
Seeing the clouds above, the bride PED for good weather.

answer

BAT

EMU

YAK

RAY

9.
Dad told us to call him WEVER we needed help.

answer

HEN

RAT

EEL

ANT

10.
Mrs Smith owned an impressive ALOGUE of history books.

answer

YAK

CAT

BAT

HEN

11+ Verbal Reasoning Practice Paper:

Complete the Word: Test 1 Answers

1.

Sarah wanted to CELEBE at her birthday party.

answer

RAT

CAT

BAT

DOE

RAT

Adding the word **RAT** to **CELEBE** creates the word **CELEBRATE**.

2.

Samir made a mess when cooking in the KITC.

answer

EWE

ANT

CAT

HEN

HEN

Adding the word **HEN** to **KITC** creates the word **KITCHEN**.

3.

The school council had a DEE about the new playground equipment.

answer

CAT

BAT

DOE

COW

BAT

Adding the word **BAT** to **DEE** creates the word **DEBATE**.

4.

Peter became very FRUSTED when completing the puzzle.

answer

EWE

COW

RAT

DOG

RAT

Adding the word **RAT** to **FRUSTED** creates the word **FRUSTRATED**.

5.

Amelia and Usman used a secret E when writing notes to each other.

answer

ANT

SOW

RAY

COD

COD

Adding the word COD to E creates the word CODE.

6.

Mum took ADVAGE of the sale in the clothes shop and bought lots of items.

answer

OWL

COD

ANT

DOG

ANT

Adding the word HEN to KITC creates the word KITCHEN.

7.

Upset, Rocco SCED down at his shoes.

answer

RAT

OWL

HEN

COW

OWL

Adding the word OWL to SCED creates the word SCOWLED.

8.

Seeing the clouds above, the bride PED for good weather.

answer

BAT

EMU

YAK

RAY

RAY

Adding the word RAY to PED creates the word PRAYED.

9.

Dad told us to call him WEVER we needed help.

answer

HEN

RAT

EEL

ANT

HEN

Adding the word HEN to WEVER creates the word WHENEVER.

10.

Mrs Smith owned an impressive ALOGUE of history books.

answer

YAK

CAT

BAT

HEN

CAT

Adding the word CAT to ALOGUE creates the word CATALOGUE.